Relation-aware simplicial attention (static text-relation route)

Zero-shot relational-table pretraining where **neighbor aggregation is conditioned on the foreign-key type**, and each relation type is represented by the **text embedding of its schema description** (e.g. `"director between movie and person"`).

The key speedrun result is **309 seconds (5m09s)** to the fixed pooled-AUROC target, improving the previous 7m26s record. The record configuration keeps the text-derived relation stream static between blocks (`update_relations=False`), uses a long Muon warmup, and evaluates the first eligible post-update checkpoint at step 100. “Static” refers to the within-forward relation state; the relation encoder and neighbor-attention parameters remain trainable.

An initialization audit measured pooled AUROC `0.8651` at step 0. This is logged outside the timer and cannot select a record or checkpoint. It establishes that the architecture/schema prior already clears the historical target, so the result must be described as time-to-verified-solution rather than pure learning speed. Per-task and within/cross-task diagnostics are reported alongside it.

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1. The idea in one line

Conventional neighbor attention asks "*how relevant is child* `s` *to parent* `q`*?*". Here the score also depends on **which relation** connects them:

```
score(q, s, r) = Σ_d  q_d · k^cell_s,d · k^rel_r,d          (per head)
value(s, r)    = v^cell_s ⊙ v^rel_r                          (FiLM-style gate)
```

`r` is a per-relation-type embedding, initialised from text and — on the winning route — **not iteratively updated** between blocks.

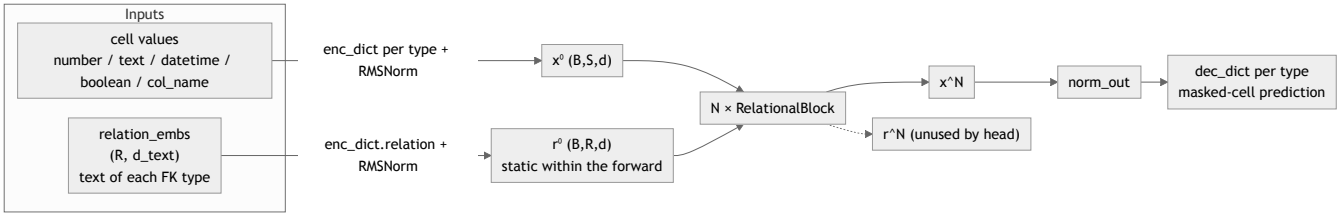
> Note (see `project_simplicial_diagnosis`): algebraically this is a rank-1 DistMult/FiLM operator, not a true 2-simplex — `r` is glued to the edge and the softmax is segmented only by `q`. The name "simplicial" is historical.

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2. Two streams

The model carries two token streams through every block:

- **`x` — cells** `(B, S, d)`: one token per (row, column) cell in the sampled subgraph.
- **`r` — relations** `(B, R, d)`: one token per foreign-key *type*, shared across all edges instantiating it.

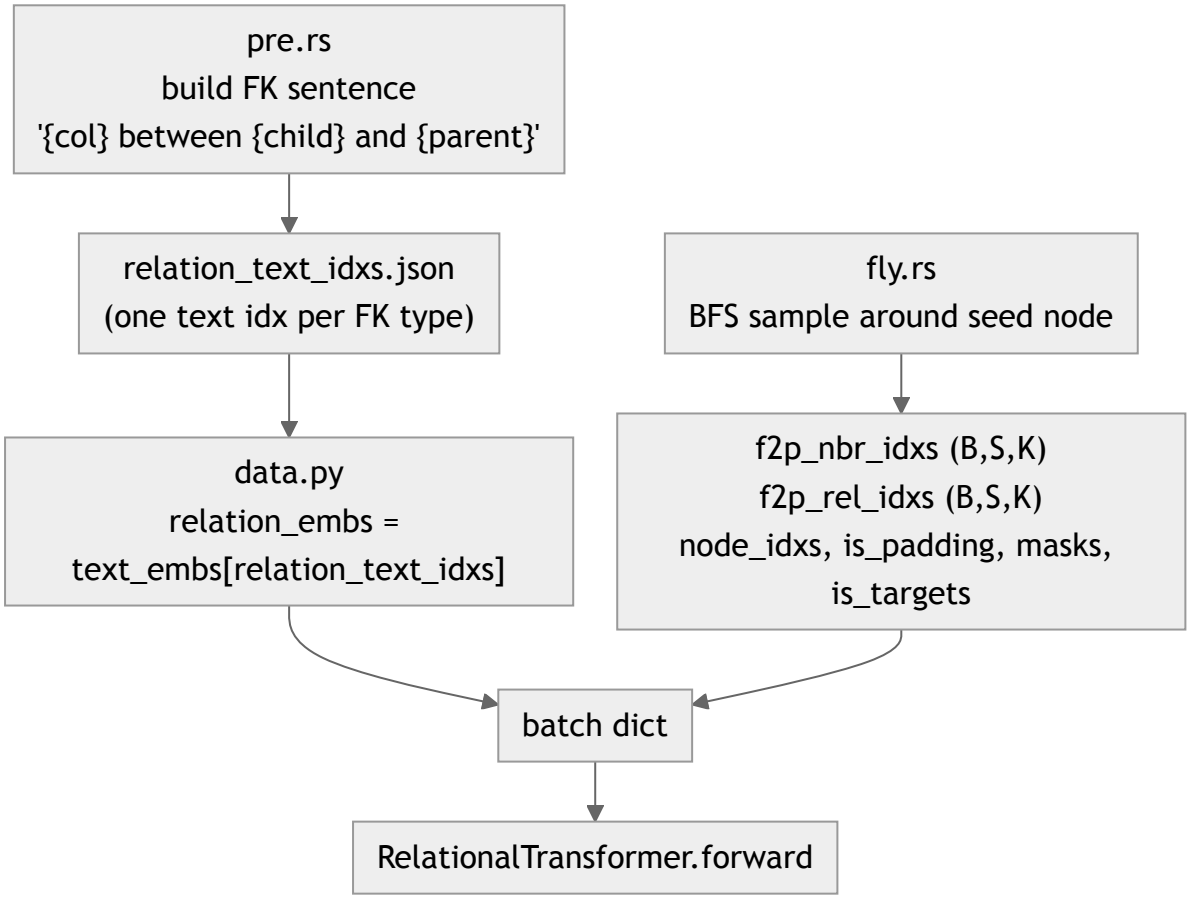


Only `x` reaches the prediction head; `r` conditions `x` but is never decoded.

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3. Data pipeline (leak-safe sampling)

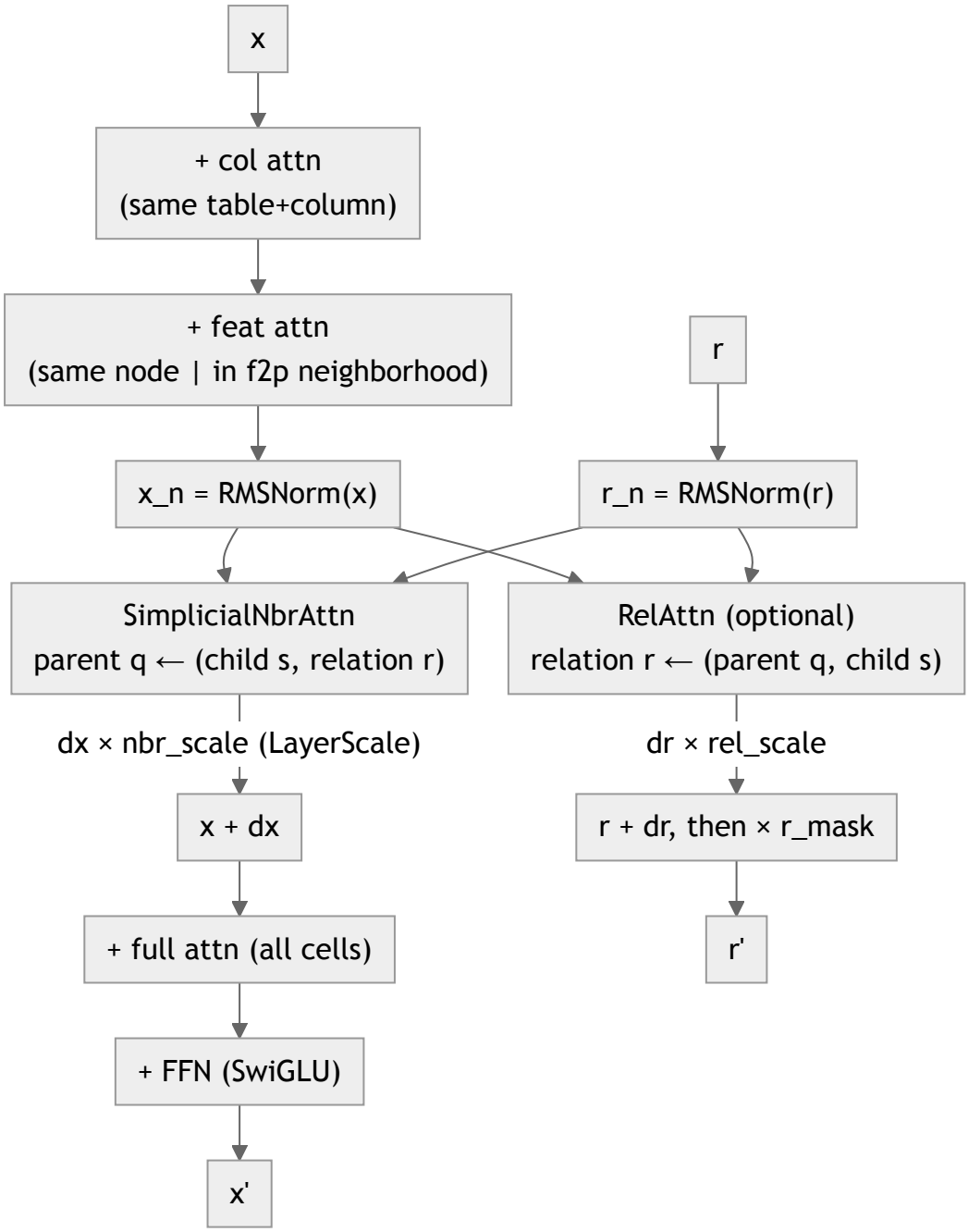
The Rust extension (`rustler/`) builds the relation text and samples a temporal, leak-free subgraph per seed node.



Leak prevention in `fly.rs` (validated):

vector	mechanism	ref
temporal	edges with `timestamp > seed_node.timestamp` are skipped	`fly.rs:447`
target value	target cell gets `is_target` + `masks=True`; model uses `mask_emb` on input, value only as label	`fly.rs:528–532`
leaky columns	`columns_to_drop` removed from seed **and** same-timestamp nodes	`fly.rs:482–483`
holdout	`train_tasks` excludes `holdout_db`; val loads only the holdout artifact → zero-shot	`nanort_train.py:79–82`

4. Inside a `RelationalBlock`



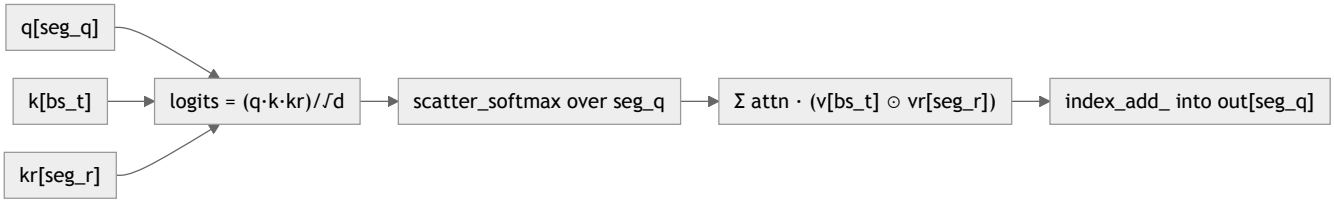
- `col` / `feat` / `full` are standard masked attentions (flex_attention).
- `SimplicialNbrAttn` updates cells; `RelAttn` updates relations.
- **`update_relations=False`** drops `RelAttn` entirely → `r` stays r^0 between blocks. This is the winning configuration; gradients still reach the relation encoder and neighbor-attention path.
- `nbr_scale` / `rel_scale` are per-channel LayerScale gates on the deltas (`simplicial_layerscale_init`, default 1.0 = plain residual).
- The relation stream is re-masked with `r_mask` after each block (defensive; the relation encoder has a bias).

5. Sparse edge-scatter (why it stays in memory)

Dense logits `(B, H, S, S, K)` would explode. `build_rel_batch` compiles the valid FK slots into flat edge triples once per batch:

```
seg_q = b·S + q   (parent cell)     → gathers queries, segments softmax, scatters cell output
bs_t  = b·S + s   (child cell)      → gathers keys/values
seg_r = b·R + r   (relation type)   → gathers relation K/V, segments RelAttn
```

`SimplicialNbrAttn` then does, over the `T` edges (all `index_select` / `index_add_`, so index traffic stays 1-D):



Per-head RMSNorm (`qk_norm`) is applied to `q`, `k`, `kr` before the triple product to keep the trilinear logit scale from collapsing the softmax entropy.

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6. SIGReg (geometry regularization)

`SIGReg` regularizes the per-cell hidden state after block `sigreg_layer` (row/col views derived from `node_idxs` and the (table,col) key). Training-only auxiliary loss: `(1−λ_row−λ_col)·L_sup + λ_row·row + λ_col·col`, trained by a separate fp32 AdamW. The record uses the globally pooled column view after block 0 with `λ_col=1e−3`; setting `sigreg_layer=None` and both lambdas to zero disables it for ablations.

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7. Record recipe

ingredient	value	why
relation stream	**static** (`update_relations=False`)	the dynamic `RelAttn` corrupted the text prior (one-hot, `r` norm ×4)
simplicial	all blocks	conditions neighbor aggregation on the clean text prior
optimizer	Muon (2-D weights) + AdamW (rest)	
muon warmup	**3000 steps**	holds the strong init; the model drifts off it even at tiny LR
SIGReg	block 0, global column view, `λ_col=1e−3`	regularizes early representation geometry
official eval	step 100 (`eval_at_step1=False`)	first eligible post-update crossing in the record run
diagnostic eval	step 0	outside timer; cannot trigger a record/checkpoint
checkpoint	best eligible post-update pooled AUROC	step 0 is explicitly excluded

Metric: `time_to_target` = historical timed wall-clock seconds until the pooled score (`val/auroc_pooled`, legacy alias `val/auroc_zero_shot`) first crosses **0.81621** on the held-out DB. The timer includes scheduled evaluation after it starts; it is not pure kernel or optimizer time.

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8. Diagnosis summary

- The complete initialized architecture carries strong zero-shot signal: pooled `0.8651`, mean per-task `0.5682` in the audited run. Which input channel causes that signal remains an ablation question; it is not attributed from this run alone.
- The pooled score is strongly influenced by cross-task alignment. Exact within/cross-task decomposition and per-task AUROC are therefore mandatory diagnostics, while the fixed pooled metric remains the leaderboard criterion.
- Low LR and long warmup preserve the initial solution long enough for the first eligible verification point; post-init gains must be reported separately.
- The current simplicial operator is a factorized trilinear/FiLM interaction on typed FK edges. It is not an explicit simplicial complex; a genuine order-2 operator (free second endpoint + joint softmax) is an open research direction.